

Impact High · Difficulty Easy-Medium · Misuse risk Low

THE MOVE

State what you need first -> Then context -> One ask at a time

START HERE

Before your next request, identify exactly what you need and say that in the first sentence. Context can follow.

SAY THIS

Lead With the Ask	<i>"I need your help with X — here is the context."</i>
Context Follows	<i>"The reason for the ask is..."</i>
Ten-Second Asks	<i>"Thirty seconds: can you approve the invoice today?"</i>
Structured Work Asks	<i>"Decision needed by Friday: which vendor do we proceed with? Detail below."</i>
Warm Asks	<i>"I have a favour to ask, and I will just ask it: could you mentor Priya this quarter?"</i>

AVOID

- When a request without context will be rejected before the person understands what they are agreeing to.
- In sensitive requests where the relationship needs warming before the ask lands.
- When the ask is secondary to sharing important information — not every message is primarily a request.

REMEMBER

Write the email, then move the last sentence to the top.